

KYLE GAARDER

Community Builder | Sales & Relationships | Event Programming

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SUMMARY

Community builder and relationship-driven seller. Closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals, achieving 46% YoY revenue growth. I bring both the community instinct and the sales hustle - building programming that attracts members and relationships that keep them.

For Vuka: I bring both community instinct and sales hustle — 30-40 new clients per summer, 94% retention through programming, and 46% revenue growth.

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX

- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
- Designed community programming that drove 94% occupancy retention for 19 consecutive months
- Ran 48 weekly community dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade programs from scratch
- Built onboarding and engagement loops converting new members into long-term residents
- Executed A/B pricing experiments driving 48% revenue lift while maintaining community quality
- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY across community and facility ops
- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition while maintaining member trust and community identity

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR

- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots community outreach
- Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand member needs and community preferences
- Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
- Led community sales and membership growth across strategy, ops, and programming

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA

- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
- Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
- Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
- Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
- Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **30-40 Clients per Summer**

Closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach, referrals, and relationships
- **46% YoY Revenue Growth**

Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth through pricing, operations, and service
- **94% Retention via Community**

Community-driven programming sustained 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
- **Investor Pilot Secured**

Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states
- **Demand Pipeline Built**

Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

- Community Sales Event Programming
- Membership Growth
- Relationship-Driven Sales
- Direct Outreach Referrals
- Engagement & Retention Events
- Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

- Bachelors in Science, Biology**
Virginia Tech
08/2010 - 05/2014
Virginia, USA
 - Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish
- GPA
3.5 / 4.0